

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Comparative and Named Real Case Studies - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Comparative and Named Real Case Studies

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Case method: mechanism, evidence, limitation and transfer

2 Whistleblowers and parliamentary conduct: courage plus institutional response

3 International models: prevention, deterrence, culture and attribution

4 Civil society, research ethics, workplace safety and rights jurisprudence

5 Prelims facts: dates, institutions, figures and legal status

6 Close-option traps: precedent, interim order, guideline, statute and inference

7 PYQ application: compare named evidence instead of decorating answers

8 Mains analysis: causal mechanisms, trade-offs and selective adaptation

9 Probable questions and examiner-ready comparative routes

10 Study links, historical PYQs and the qualified rule-case answer spine

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Comparative and Named Real Case Studies - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g1 **PYQ ownership:** Questions labelled as official reproduce the locally held UPSC GS-IV papers; routed historical demands are explicitly neutral renderings rather than invented quotations.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

An answer praises personal courage but proposes no secure channel, anti-retaliation measure or investigation route. What essential institutional lesson is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- C. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Manjunath and Dubey reveal an unresolved protection gap** is the controlling principle. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A department separates the informer's identity, assesses threats, preserves evidence and routes the allegation independently. Which case-derived mechanism is being applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Manjunath and Dubey reveal an unresolved protection gap** is the controlling principle. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in

the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

A candidate says the 2014 enactment immediately supplied every whistleblower with an operational statutory remedy. Which legal-status distinction defeats the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: C

Explanation: The 2014 protection statute is not operational merely because enacted is the controlling principle. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

An answer distinguishes enacted text, commencement and the interim administrative route. Which form of legal precision does this demonstrate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- C. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.

Answer: D

Explanation: The 2014 protection statute is not operational merely because enacted is the controlling principle. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A portal hides the complainant's name on screen but circulates an identifiable attachment to the accused chain. Which protection failure remains? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: A

Explanation: Confidentiality is a process, not a slogan is the controlling principle. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

Only a designated cell can decrypt identity data, and every access is logged and reviewable. Which practical safeguard is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Confidentiality is a process, not a slogan is the controlling principle. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

An agency publicly condemns an official solely because a protected complaint was filed. Which due-process error has occurred? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.

Answer: C

Explanation: A whistleblower allegation still requires fair verification is the controlling principle. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

Identity protection operates alongside independent evidence testing and a fair hearing. Which balanced rule follows from the named whistleblower cases? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: D

Explanation: A whistleblower allegation still requires fair verification is the controlling principle. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

A legislator claims parliamentary privilege prevents the House from responding to proven paid advocacy by a member. Which precedent answers the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- C. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: A

Explanation: Mudgal established a parliamentary corrective precedent is the controlling principle. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

The House acts on a committee's evidence and protects the integrity of representation. Which institutional capacity is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.

Answer: B

Explanation: Mudgal established a parliamentary corrective precedent is the controlling principle. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

An answer cites the expulsions as proof that internal ethics systems automatically detect all misconduct. Which limitation has been ignored? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: C

Explanation: Cash-for-questions confirms power but also reactivity is the controlling principle. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

A reform retains expulsion for proved misconduct but adds disclosure analytics and proactive ethics monitoring. Which gap is it addressing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- C. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- D. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.

Answer: D

Explanation: Cash-for-questions confirms power but also reactivity is the controlling principle. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

A social audit meeting gathers grievances without obtaining the underlying records. Which distinctive evidentiary element of Jan Sunwai is absent? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- C. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: A

Explanation: **MKSS Jan Sunwai converts records into public proof** is the controlling principle. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

Villagers compare muster-roll names with actual workers and publicly record contradictions. Which accountability mechanism is operating? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.

Answer: B

Explanation: **MKSS Jan Sunwai converts records into public proof** is the controlling principle. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

Residents complain of shortages but cannot inspect stock or issue records. Which information bridge would the Parivartan example recommend? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.

Answer: C

Explanation: Parivartan made PDS diversion testable through RTI is the controlling principle. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A community reconciles shop registers, beneficiary accounts and physical delivery before seeking action. Which case mechanism is replicated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: D

Explanation: Parivartan made PDS diversion testable through RTI is the controlling principle. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

A district buys computers but citizens still require a broker to obtain every certified record. Which Gyandoot design objective remains unmet? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- C. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: A

Explanation: Gyandoot reduced costly human intermediation is the controlling principle. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

Village kiosks publish service access, fees and grievance registration without repeated office visits. Which mechanism is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.

Answer: B

Explanation: Gyandoot reduced costly human intermediation is the controlling principle. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

An office scans records but preserves an undefined approval queue controlled by one official. Why is this unlike the strongest Bhoomi lesson? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Bhoomi changed the mutation workflow** is the controlling principle. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

A mutation request automatically generates notice, deadline and auditable status. Which anti-corruption design principle is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- C. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- D. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.

Answer: D

Explanation: **Bhoomi changed the mutation workflow** is the controlling principle. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

A ministry claims any database conversion necessarily lowers bribery. Which named comparison directly challenges that inference? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- C. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: A

Explanation: CARD is the necessary digital-government counter-example is the controlling principle. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

A project evaluation asks whether approval discretion, valuation opacity and citizen dependence actually changed. Which CARD-derived test is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.

Answer: B

Explanation: CARD is the necessary digital-government counter-example is the controlling principle. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

Two portals use similar software but only one removes manual discretion. What variable should an ethical evaluation prioritise? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.

Answer: C

Explanation: Technology must be tied to the corruption mechanism is the controlling principle. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A reform maps each bribery opportunity to a redesigned step and measurable citizen outcome. Which comparative lesson is followed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Technology must be tied to the corruption mechanism is the controlling principle. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A government copies only investigative powers and omits prevention review and public education. Which part of the ICAC mechanism has been lost? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- C. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: A

Explanation: Hong Kong ICAC uses three mutually supporting prongs is the controlling principle. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

Investigators pursue offences while specialists redesign procedures and educators build public resistance to bribery. Which model is represented? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.

Answer: B

Explanation: Hong Kong ICAC uses three mutually supporting prongs is the controlling principle. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

An answer repeats the lower fine printed in the ARC's 2007 annexure as present law. Which source-handling error has occurred? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: C

Explanation: Singapore penalties must use current official figures is the controlling principle. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A candidate dates the ARC figure, then cites CPIB's current maximum separately. Which comparative practice is correct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- C. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- D. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.

Answer: D

Explanation: Singapore penalties must use current official figures is the controlling principle. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

A student states that modern Korean law automatically punishes an offender's grandchildren. Which evidentiary caveat is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- C. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: A

Explanation: Korea's wider liability claim requires attribution is the controlling principle. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

An essay uses the claim hypothetically, identifies its ARC attribution and examines individual fairness. Which disciplined use is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.

Answer: B

Explanation: Korea's wider liability claim requires attribution is the controlling principle. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

A proposal assumes harsher punishment mechanically produces a cleaner administration. Which current comparison supplies a caution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.

Answer: C

Explanation: Finland and Thailand defeat single-lever explanations is the controlling principle. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

An answer links sanctions with rule of law, enforcement, transparency and culture. Which multi-causal conclusion follows? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Finland and Thailand defeat single-lever explanations is the controlling principle. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

An employer in 2005 argues that no duty existed because Parliament had not legislated. Which judicial mechanism defeats the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- C. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: A

Explanation: Vishaka was binding interim judicial law is the controlling principle. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

A present answer cites the 2013 statute while using Vishaka for its constitutional foundation. Which historical sequence is correct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.

Answer: B

Explanation: Vishaka was binding interim judicial law is the controlling principle. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

The presiding officer is the respondent's direct business partner but refuses recusal because the committee exists by law. Which limitation is exposed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: C

Explanation: A statutory committee is not automatically impartial is the controlling principle. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

An alternate unconflicted process preserves the complainant's safety and the respondent's hearing. Which rule-case balance is achieved? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- C. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- D. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.

Answer: D

Explanation: A statutory committee is not automatically impartial is the controlling principle. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A poor participant signs a technical form after being told treatment depends on joining. Which research-ethics defects remain? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- C. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: A

Explanation: ICMR ethics makes consent an ongoing protection is the controlling principle. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

The committee reviews recruitment pressure, translated information, withdrawal rights and adverse events. Which ethical framework is operating? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.

Answer: B

Explanation: ICMR ethics makes consent an ongoing protection is the controlling principle. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

A committee routinely approves sponsor submissions without reading adverse-event data. Which implementation limitation is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Guidelines depend on institutional enforcement quality** is the controlling principle. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

Independent members demand complete safety data and suspend recruitment pending clarification. Which oversight responsibility is fulfilled? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: D

Explanation: **Guidelines depend on institutional enforcement quality** is the controlling principle. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

A mob threatens non-citizens while officials treat nationality as a reason for inaction. Which constitutional precedent requires protection? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- C. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: A

Explanation: **NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh protects every person's life** is the controlling principle. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

Police prevent violence and authorities process claims lawfully without promising permanent residence. Which precise duty is respected? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.

Answer: B

Explanation: **NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh protects every person's life** is the controlling principle. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

An answer calls the interim order a final universal rejection of refugee protection. Which precedential overstatement is present? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: C

Explanation: Salimullah is an interim-order authority with limits is the controlling principle. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

A decision protects Article 21 process while separately examining lawful removal authority. Which paired reading with NHRC is appropriate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- C. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- D. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.

Answer: D

Explanation: Salimullah is an interim-order authority with limits is the controlling principle. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

A district delays preventive action because a future commission can investigate later. Which mechanism limitation has been misunderstood? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- C. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: A

Explanation: Bhagalpur and Nanavati are retrospective accountability tools is the controlling principle. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

Administration acts immediately, preserves records and later cooperates with independent inquiry. Which complementary design is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.

Answer: B

Explanation: Bhagalpur and Nanavati are retrospective accountability tools is the controlling principle. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

Police omit the arrest memo because they consider the suspect obviously guilty. Which constitutional error does the precedent expose? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.

Answer: C

Explanation: D.K. Basu safeguards operate before guilt is known is the controlling principle. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

Officers document custody and medical condition while continuing a lawful investigation. Which rule-case mechanism is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: D

Explanation: D.K. Basu safeguards operate before guilt is known is the controlling principle. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 - 20 marks

Question: GS-IV Q12: Edward Snowden, a computer expert and former CIA systems administrator, released confidential Government documents to the press about Government surveillance programmes. Do you agree that Snowden's actions were ethically justified even if legally prohibited? Why or why not? Make an argument by weighing the competing values in this case. (250 words)

Source / ownership: Faithful condensed routing verified against books\more_previous_papers\GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV.pdf, page 11. The official printed stem is longer and controls exact wording; this entry preserves its actor, act, demand and word limit.

Model solution

Snowden's disclosure can be ethically defended only through a necessity and proportionality test. The public-interest claim is that secret mass surveillance affects privacy, autonomy and democratic consent. Satyendra Dubey and Manjunath Shanmugam similarly show why internal wrongdoing may require protected escalation when ordinary hierarchy is implicated. Their cases prove the need for voice, not an unlimited licence to disclose every secret.

Competing values are national security, confidentiality, lawful office, institutional trust and possible harm to operations or persons. A responsible whistleblower should first test whether an independent authorised channel is safe and effective, authenticate evidence, minimise unrelated disclosure and choose the least harmful route. MKSS offers the opposite context: official records were publicly cross-verified because community scrutiny was the accountability mechanism; intelligence material demands narrower handling.

Therefore legality is morally relevant but not conclusive. Disclosure is strongest where wrongdoing is serious, internal remedies are captured or futile, evidence is reliable, public benefit is high and avoidable harm is minimised. It is weakest where mass release is indiscriminate. The cases support protected, proportionate truth-telling plus independent review, not either blind secrecy or heroic law-breaking as an automatic rule.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 - 10 marks

Question: "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption". Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. (150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-GeneralStudies-IV.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

I agree when non-performance is a deliberate misuse of entrusted power for private benefit, protection of allies or foreseeable public harm. Satyendra Dubey's road-contract disclosures show how official inaction toward credible corruption can enable systemic loss. Parivartan likewise showed that failure to reconcile PDS stock records allowed diversion to persist.

But every shortfall is not corrupt. CARD's limited anti-corruption result warns that poor system design may preserve discretion even when individual staff operate the new technology. Capacity shortage, legal ambiguity, negligence and bona fide error require different diagnoses.

The test should identify a clear duty, knowledge, ability to act, motive, benefit, harm and evidence. Wilful omission for improper advantage is corrupt; inability or reasonable error is not. Fair inquiry protects both accountability and honest administration.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 - 10 marks

Question: What do you understand by probity in governance? Based on your understanding of the term, suggest measures for ensuring probity in government. (150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-GeneralStudies-IV.pdf, page 3.

Model solution

Probity is demonstrable integrity in public power: legality, impartiality, transparent reasons, answerability and fidelity to public purpose. It must be designed into systems. MKSS Jan Sunwai made probity testable by comparing public records with community evidence. Bhoomi reduced routine gatekeeping through automatic notices and deadlines, whereas CARD warns that digitisation without process redesign may leave corruption unchanged.

Government should publish criteria and records, protect whistleblowers, disclose conflicts, conduct independent social audit, reduce monopoly discretion and ensure time-bound remedies. Parliamentary ethics systems should learn from Mudgal and cash-for-questions by adding proactive monitoring to their proven corrective power.

Hong Kong's ICAC adds a useful synthesis: enforcement, prevention and community education should reinforce one another. Probity is sustained when ethical culture, auditable process and fair consequence operate together.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 - 10 marks

Question: An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-21-GENSTUDIESPAPER-IV-110122.pdf, page 3.

Model solution

Social audit makes official performance answerable to affected people. MKSS's Jan Sunwai joined muster rolls and vouchers with public cross-verification, exposing false workers, bills and completion claims. Parivartan similarly used PDS stock registers to test whether recorded supplies reached citizens. These cases show that independence requires access to usable records, community voice, protection against retaliation and mandatory action-taken reports.

The mechanism has limits. A public hearing is not a criminal trial, and organisational capacity varies. For the judiciary, administrative expenditure, listing systems and service delivery may be audited, but the merits of judgments belong to appeal and review so decisional independence is preserved.

Thus social audit should produce verified evidence and institutional learning, then route misconduct to the competent forum. It strengthens accountability without replacing investigation or adjudication.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 - 10 marks

Question: Whistle-blower, who reports corruption and illegal activities, wrongdoing and misconduct to the concerned authorities, runs the risk of being exposed to grave danger, physical harm and victimization by vested interests, accused persons and his team. What policy measures would you suggest to strengthen protection mechanism to safeguard the whistle-blower? (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER IV-190922.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey show that courage without institutional protection can become fatal. Policy should provide a secure authorised channel, identity separation, access logs, immediate threat assessment, police protection where necessary, safe transfer, service protection, compensation and punishment for retaliation. Evidence must be preserved outside the accused hierarchy and examined by an independent authority.

The legal gap must be stated precisely: a 2025 official Lok Sabha answer said the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force; the PIDPI administrative mechanism remains relevant but is not an equivalent statutory shield. Time-bound acknowledgement, investigation updates and external review are therefore vital.

Protection should coexist with good-faith thresholds and fair verification. The informant is protected from retaliation; the accused is protected from allegation-based guilt.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2023 - 10 marks

Question: "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society? (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV-180923.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

Corruption reflects weakened honesty, fairness and public spirit, but values are reinforced or eroded by institutions. Hong Kong's ICAC combines community education with prevention and enforcement, showing that moral learning needs credible systems. Finland's CPI 2025 position, despite no single dedicated anti-corruption statute, similarly cautions against reducing integrity to punishment alone.

Families, schools, professional bodies and public leaders should reject admiration of illicit wealth, teach constitutional morality and reward public-minded conduct. Government should protect whistleblowers, publish reasons and records, reduce discretionary bottlenecks and support citizen verification such as MKSS Jan Sunwai. Thailand's severe-penalty yet weaker CPI position warns that deterrence without institutional culture is insufficient.

Core values rise when ethical conduct is socially respected, administratively feasible and fairly enforced consistently.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: The 'Code of Conduct' and 'Code of Ethics' are the sources of guidance in public administration. There is code of conduct already in operation, whereas code of ethics is not yet put in place. Suggest a suitable model for code of ethics to maintain integrity, probity and transparency in governance. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording, with punctuation normalised, verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

A code of ethics should state public-service purposes rather than merely prohibited acts: constitutional fidelity, impartiality, truthfulness, stewardship, dignity, courage and reasoned accountability. Each value needs an operational rule. Dubey and Manjunath support protected reporting; MKSS supports public access and verification; D.K. Basu shows that dignity requires documented procedure even for unpopular persons.

The code should require conflict disclosure, written reasons, recusal, protection of personal data, fair hearing, safe consultation and refusal of unlawful directions. Training should use named comparative cases, while independent ethics advisers and annual public reporting convert aspiration into practice.

Enforcement must be proportionate and reviewable. Mudgal shows meaningful consequence for proven breach, but CARD warns that formal adoption without process change may achieve little. A living code links values, decision tests, support and fair accountability.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years. Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

Female public servants may face harassment, stereotyping, unsafe postings, exclusion from informal networks, disproportionate care burdens and retaliation for reporting misconduct. These barriers impair equal opportunity and may pressure officers to tolerate unethical conduct. Vishaka located workplace safety in Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21; the 2013 statute supplies a formal prevention and redress process.

Measures should include safe infrastructure and transport, transparent posting and promotion criteria, flexible but non-penalising work arrangements, mentoring, leadership representation and confidential reporting. Internal Committees must be properly composed, independent and free from personal conflict; their mere existence does not guarantee fairness.

As ICMR ethics shows in another domain, vulnerable-position safeguards need continuing oversight, not one-time paper compliance. Equality, safety and impartial process enable both efficiency and probity.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence of the rule of law." Examine the significance of constitutional morality for public servant highlighting the role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording, with the paper's spelling normalised, verified against books\mains\UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 4.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

Constitutional morality requires officials to exercise power through equality, dignity, liberty, reason and lawful procedure, especially when popularity points elsewhere. NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh required protection of non-citizens from violence because Article 21 covers every person. D.K. Basu similarly made custody safeguards obligatory before guilt is determined.

For good governance, this ethic demands transparent criteria, recorded reasons, hearing, recusal and review. Vishaka shows constitutional values filling a legislative vacuum, while the later workplace statute shows their translation into durable procedure. Salimullah must be cited cautiously: its 2021 interim order addressed deportation relief and lawful procedure, not every refugee-law question finally.

Thus civil education teaches the values, but institutions make them habitual. Constitutional morality restrains majoritarian impulse and official convenience while keeping accountability evidence-based and reviewable.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2022 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: an investigative journalist uncovers a stone-mining mafia involving corrupt police and civil officials and a politically connected media owner, while inducement and pressure are used to suppress publication. Evaluate the options, ethical dilemmas and appropriate response. (250 words)

Source / ownership: Neutral demand routed from books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER IV-190922.pdf, page 10. The official multi-part case stem controls its complete facts and wording.

Model solution

The journalist faces truth and public interest against personal safety, source protection, confidentiality, editorial loyalty and the risk that premature publication may destroy evidence. Manjunath and Dubey warn that exposing a profitable network without protection can invite lethal retaliation. The first duty is therefore neither silence nor reckless heroism.

He should authenticate permits, transport records, payments and communications; preserve encrypted copies in independent custody; document threats and inducements; obtain legal and trusted editorial review; and assess source-specific risk. A secure disclosure to a competent independent authority should precede or accompany carefully timed publication. Unrelated personal data and operational details should be minimised.

MKSS and Parivartan show the power of transaction-level records and public verification, but the mining network also shows their limit where police, administration, politics and media ownership are captured. Escalation may require judicial protection or another legally competent forum. Publication should explain evidence and uncertainty, not pronounce guilt.

The long-term remedy is network-focused: protect witnesses, reconcile extraction and royalty data, rotate captured posts, disclose ownership conflicts and create independent complaint routes. The qualified verdict is protected, evidence-led disclosure using the least harmful effective channel, followed by fair investigation and systemic repair.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Compare the ethical significance of Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey without reducing either case to a hero story. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Both officers demonstrate integrity and moral courage against organised wrongdoing: Manjunath challenged fuel adulteration, while Dubey exposed corruption in highway construction. Their deaths prove that individual virtue can reveal serious misconduct but cannot supply its own protection.

The institutional mechanism is therefore central: a safe authorised channel, identity separation, threat assessment, independent evidence custody, anti-retaliation remedies and time-bound investigation. The unresolved legal position matters. An official 2025 Lok Sabha answer stated that the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force; PIDPI remains an administrative route, not an equivalent statutory guarantee.

The limitation is equally important: protection cannot make an allegation self-proving. Fair verification and hearing remain necessary. The cases support protected courage joined to institutional duty, not martyrdom as a governance model.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: What do the Mudgal and cash-for-questions cases establish about parliamentary ethics, and what do they fail to establish? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Mudgal in 1951 established that proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours could be treated as conduct incompatible with membership. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode confirmed that Houses could investigate clear evidence and expel ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member. Together they show meaningful institutional self-discipline and reputational protection of representative office.

They do not establish an effective preventive system. Mudgal followed a complaint, while the later expulsions followed a media sting. The mechanism was reactive and evidence-triggered; it says little about undetected conduct. Nor does expulsion replace criminal or other legal process where applicable.

Reform should preserve fair committee inquiry and decisive consequence while adding conflict disclosure, gift and interest registers, proactive pattern review and reasoned public reporting. The cases prove corrective capacity, not automatic ethical health.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare MKSS Jan Sunwai and Parivartan as civil-society accountability mechanisms. Why are they more than generic examples of activism? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Both cases converted information rights into verifiable public claims. MKSS obtained muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates, then used Jan Sunwai to compare them with community testimony. False workers, bills and completion claims became publicly demonstrable. Parivartan obtained fair-price-shop stock registers and compared recorded grain and oil with actual PDS delivery, exposing diversion.

Their common mechanism is an evidence chain: access -> intelligible records -> affected-person verification -> public hearing or reconciliation -> reasoned demand for action. This differs from unsupported accusation and helps overcome information asymmetry. MKSS also influenced Rajasthan's ward-sabha social-audit role, showing institutional absorption.

The models have limits. They depend on organised citizens, record access, local safety and a responsive consequence forum. Public findings are not convictions, and elite or violent capture may require protected escalation. Therefore replication needs facilitation funds, open data, witness protection and mandatory action-taken reports. Their lesson is not merely that civil society is beneficial, but that documentary access plus collective verification can transform private suspicion into accountable public evidence. Periodic independent evaluation should also test inclusion, record accuracy and whether verified findings actually produce timely corrective action.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Bhoomi and CARD to explain when digital governance reduces corruption and when it merely computerises an existing problem. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Bhoomi combined record computerisation with workflow change. Kiosk access reduced dependence on intermediaries; automatic mutation notices and a defined objection period constrained routine gatekeeping and created an auditable sequence. The ARC cites a 2002 evaluation finding efficiency gains and reduced corruption.

CARD also computerised registration administration, but the ARC-cited Ramanathan and Balakrishnan evaluation found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices. The defensible comparison is not superior hardware. It is whether the reform changed valuation, approval, queue and citizen-dependence mechanisms that generated rents. Digital storage can coexist with opaque discretion.

A credible project should therefore map each corruption opportunity, automate only rule-bound steps, publish fees and deadlines, log overrides, provide appeal and test actual citizen experience. Gyandoot adds accessibility through local kiosks, but technology still cannot solve collusive procurement or captured enforcement.

The verdict is conditional: digitisation reduces corruption when it redesigns the decision process and makes exceptions visible; otherwise it may give an old monopoly a faster interface. Procurement, maintenance, digital exclusion and grievance independence must also be audited throughout the project's life cycle.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Design an India-adapted anti-corruption strategy using Hong Kong's ICAC, Singapore's CPIB regime, the Korea attribution caveat, and the Finland-Thailand comparison. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

India should borrow mechanisms, not reputations. Hong Kong's ICAC supplies the organising architecture: enforcement, corruption prevention and community education work through distinct but connected departments. India can adapt this through Union, State and district networks rather than one city-scale campaign. Prevention teams should redesign high-risk services; education should use schools, professional bodies and local languages; investigators should remain operationally independent and reviewable.

Singapore contributes credible deterrence. CPIB's current official statement gives a maximum S\$100,000 fine or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years for Government or public-body contract corruption, plus repayment consequences. India should draw the lesson of certainty, asset tracing and equal reach, not copy sentence numbers without comparing legal systems and due process.

The ARC attributes extended family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that feature is lacking. It should not be asserted as current Korean law. Even hypothetically, collective liability would offend individual culpability; targeted beneficial-ownership scrutiny is a fairer adaptation.

CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2 and Thailand at 33 and rank 116 of 182. Finland's dispersed legal framework and Thailand's severe penalties caution that drafting or harshness alone cannot create integrity. India's package should combine transparent systems, protected voice, swift fair enforcement, civic norms and measured outcomes. The conclusion is selective adaptation governed by federal scale, constitutional rights and verified evidence.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Apply the rule-case mechanism and limitation method to workplace harassment, research ethics, refugee protection, communal violence and custodial justice. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

The method has four moves: state the governing rule, show the named case's mechanism, identify its remedy and retain its limitation. For workplace harassment, Vishaka derived preventive and redress duties from Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21 until legislation. The 2013 statute supplies an Internal Committee and timelines, but formal constitution does not cure conflict or capture.

For research, ICMR's 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added protection for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight. A signed form is insufficient where recruitment is coercive or safety data is distorted; enforcement quality varies by institution.

For refugees, NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh confirms Article 21 protection for every person and required State protection of Chakma and Hajong refugees. Mohammad Salimullah's 2021 interim order declined deportation relief subject to lawful procedure; it must not be inflated into a final settlement of every non-refoulement question. Apply dignity and process without inventing an absolute right to remain.

Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries support retrospective truth and accountability but cannot replace immediate prevention, protection and lawful crisis command. D.K. Basu makes arrest records, communication and medical checks independent duties before guilt is known.

Thus named authority is useful only when linked to the decision mechanism and residual gap. The answer should move from rule to action, safeguard, review and qualified remedy, never from famous name to automatic conclusion. That discipline also prevents false equivalence across unlike institutional contexts.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.